Offshore Data Storage Standard

Introduction

Data is a valuable asset to business and government, and as such, it is imperative that state data be stored securely. Offshore data storage is a popular industry option, particularly for cloud storage. However, because other countries and regions use different guidelines, international laws and regulations, offshore storage options may be less secure and more vulnerable to security incidents than data stored within the United States. Offshore data storage also increases the risk that data stored offshore could be subject to the sovereign control of another country. To reduce the security and jurisdictional concerns inherent to offshore data storage, OMES requires state data to remain within the boundaries of the U.S.

Purpose

This document establishes the standard for state data to be stored within the boundaries of the U.S.

Definitions

- Offshore – a location that is outside the physical borders of the U.S.
- Follow-the-sun model – IT support model that utilizes global resources to provide 24/7 support for IT services and solutions.

Standard

OMES requires all state data be hosted, stored, processed, transmitted, accessed and disposed of by approved vendors within the boundaries of the U.S.

State agency systems and data shall not be accessible from outside the physical boundaries of the U.S. unless following the International Travel Standard, which is limited to employees.

Vendors/suppliers may be allowed to provide a follow-the-sun service model in order to provide 24/7 support for IT services, cloud management, incident response, troubleshooting, customer support- and application development for services and solutions utilized by state agencies.

Offshore support is only permitted on systems that use public data. Any regulated data, i.e. HIPAA, FERPA, CJI, etc., must be supported by onshore resources only. Vendors/suppliers are required to provide the list of countries services will be provided from in order to ensure no undue risk to state data and systems will be incurred.

Compliance

This standard shall take effect upon publication and is made pursuant to Title 62 O.S. §§ 34.11.1 and 34.12 and Title 62 O.S. § 35.8. OMES IS may amend and publish the amended standards policies and standards at any time. Compliance is expected with all published policies and standards, and any published amendments thereof. Employees found in violation of this standard may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

Rationale

To ensure efficient, secure, and cost-effective delivery of essential public services, all state agency IT purchases and projects must receive central approval. This allows the Chief Information Officer to evaluate agency needs and capabilities, strengthen data protection and security and streamline and consolidate systems to reduce costs for taxpayers.

References

- International Travel Standard.

Revision history

This standard is subject to periodic review to ensure relevancy.

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